

En passant changes two lines

Foundations

THE IDEA

An en passant capture is available immediately after an opposing pawn advances two squares and lands beside your pawn on its fifth rank. Your pawn captures as though the opposing pawn advanced one square. Waiting one turn loses that opportunity.

WORKED EXAMPLE

White pawn e5, Black pawn d7: after ...d5, White may play exd6 en passant, removing the pawn from d5. Both the e-file and fifth rank can change because two pawns leave their previous squares.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

Can an en passant capture be illegal even when the pawn pattern fits?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Yes. If removing those pawns exposes your king to a rook, bishop, or queen, the capture is illegal. Apply the same king-safety test as for every other move.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Remove the captured pawn mentally before evaluating en passant.